

Quick Start Guide

A native macOS app that tidies a messy folder of movie & TV files into the clean, predictable layout that Plex and Jellyfin expect — so your library just works. You preview everything first; nothing changes on disk until you say so.

TV EPISODES BECOME

Show Name / Season N / Show Name
S##E##.mkv

MOVIES BECOME

Movie Name (Year) / Movie Name
(Year).mkv

For: anyone organising a download/media folder · **Platform:** macOS 14 or later ·

Reading time: ~5 minutes

It's safe to explore

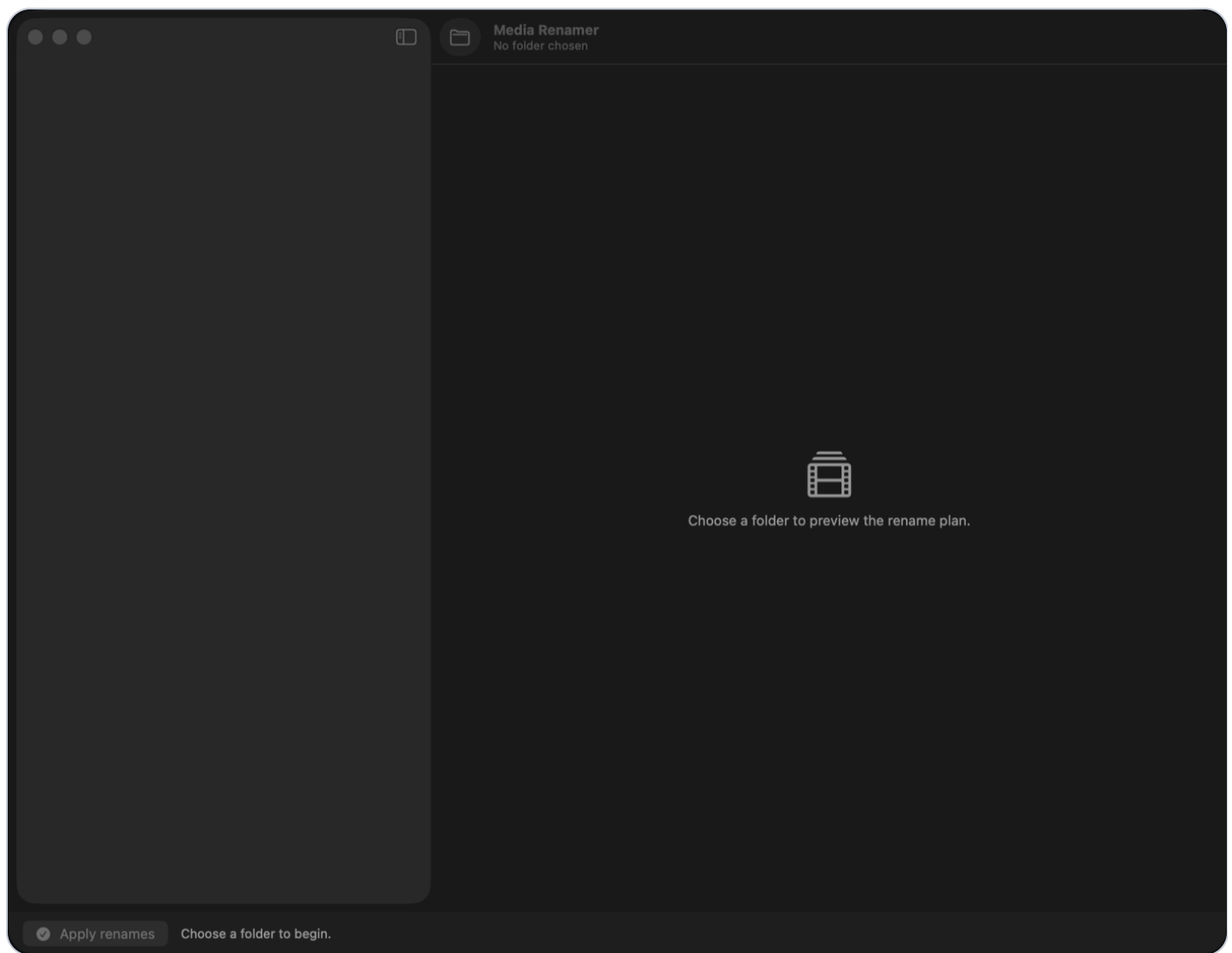
Choosing a folder only *preview*s a plan — it reads names, it doesn't touch your files. The app changes nothing on disk until you click **Apply** and confirm. Renaming never overwrites an existing file, and anything sent to the Trash can be restored with Finder's **Put Back**. Still, the golden rule with any bulk tool: **try it on a copy first**.

The 30-second version

- 1 **Choose a folder** of video files (and their subtitles).
- 2 **Read the preview** — every old → new name, grouped into TV, Movies, Unchanged, and Skipped.
- 3 **Adjust if needed** — fix a title, keep or un-keep an acronym, choose which junk to bin, label duplicate versions.
- 4 **Apply** — confirm, and the renames happen (plus junk to the Trash, and empty leftover folders cleaned up).

1 Open the app & choose a folder

When Media Renamer launches it's empty and waiting. Click **Choose Folder...** (the folder button at the top-left) and pick the folder you want to organise — for example a Downloads/TV folder full of scene-named files. The app scans one level deep: loose files at the top, plus the immediate sub-folders.



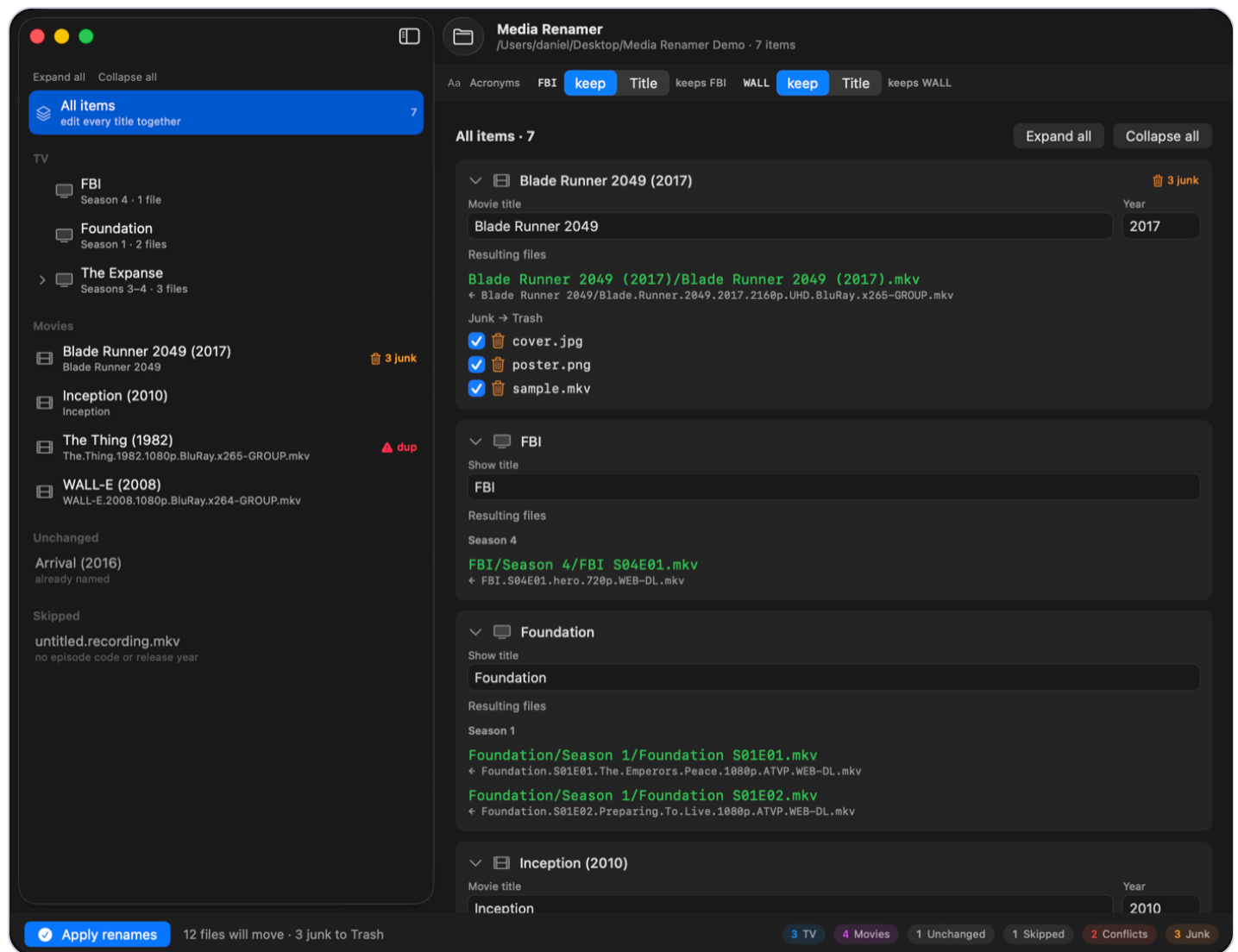
The start screen. Click **Choose Folder...** to point the app at your media.

2 Read the plan

As soon as you pick a folder you get a complete preview — no changes yet. The **sidebar** on the left groups everything it found:

- **TV** and **Movies** — the files that will be renamed.
- **Unchanged** — already named correctly (the app leaves them alone).
- **Skipped** — it couldn't recognise an episode code or a year, so it won't guess.

Select **All items** at the top to see every entry as a card showing the live rename — the new name in **green**, with the original filename beneath it. Along the bottom, colour-coded **summary chips** tally how many items fall into each bucket, and the bar tells you exactly how many files will move and how much junk will go to the Trash.



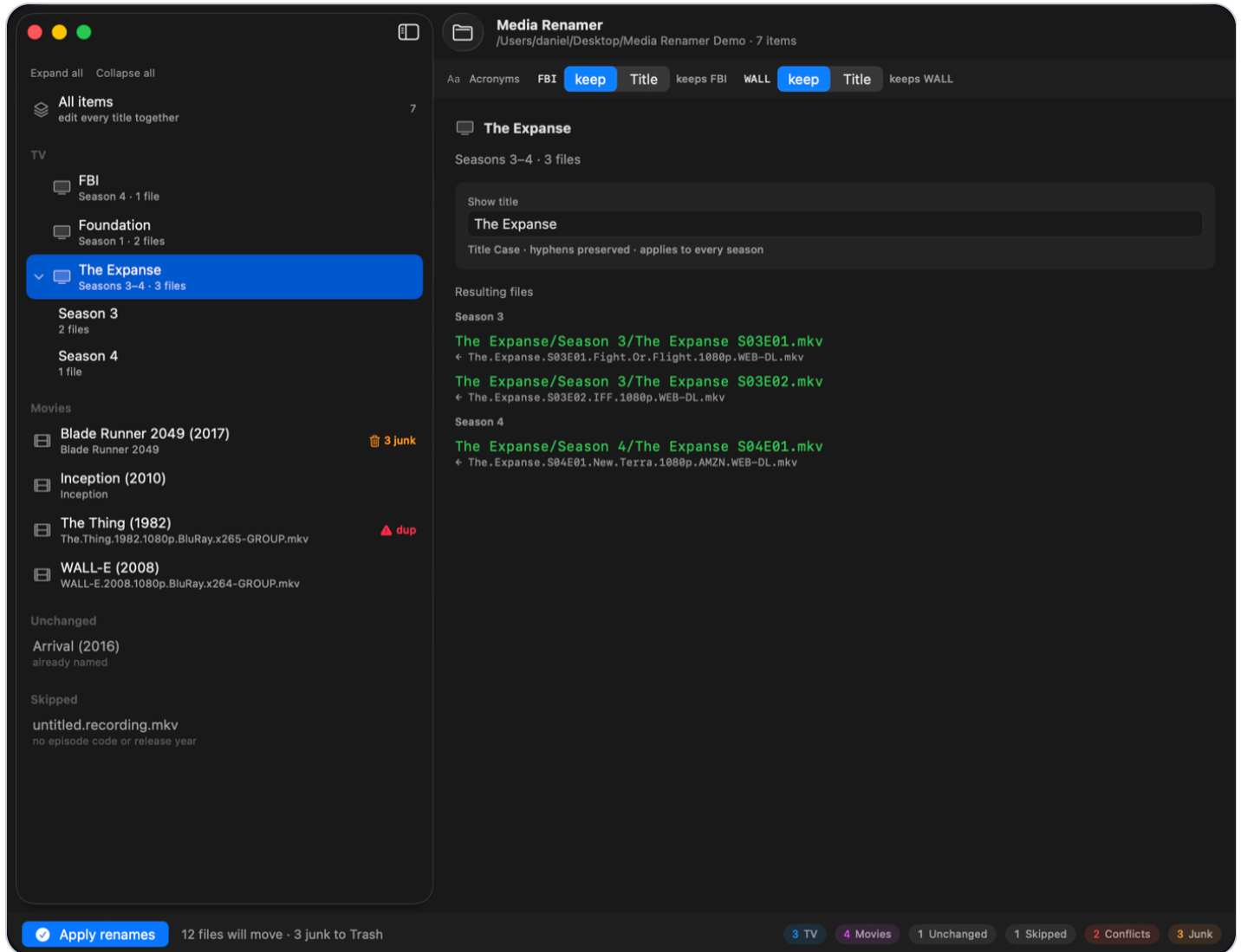
The **All items** overview — the whole plan at a glance. Each card shows the new name (green) above the original. The colour-coded chips along the bottom tally each bucket — here 3 TV · 4 Movies · 1 Unchanged · 1 Skipped · 2 Conflicts · 3 Junk (the red **Conflicts** chip appears only when duplicates are found).

Edit a title or year anytime

Every item has editable **Title** (and, for movies, **Year**) fields. Type a correction and the plan re-computes instantly — including the destination folder name. Titles are Title-Cased automatically, and hyphens are preserved.

3 TV shows & seasons

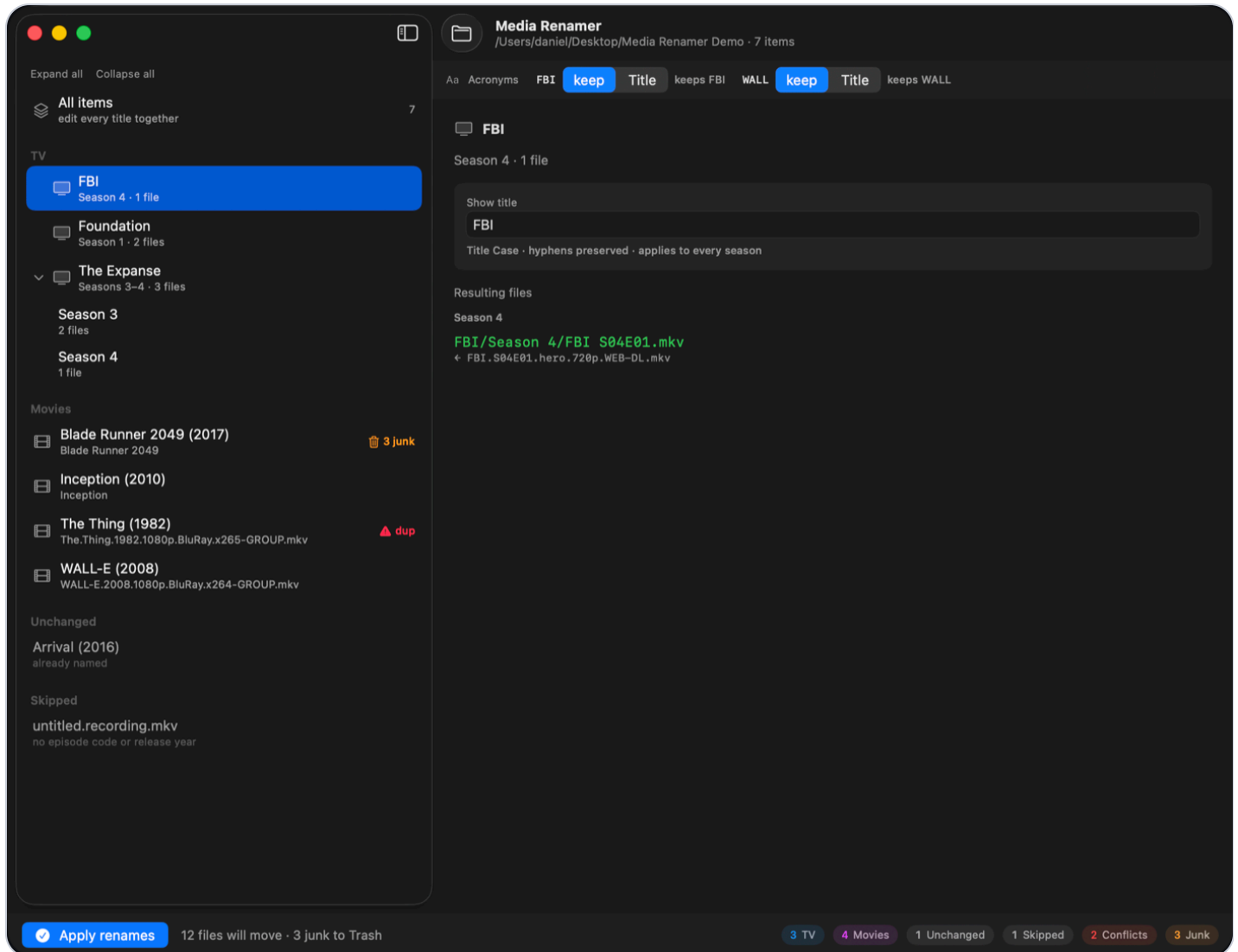
A show that spans several seasons appears as a single row that **expands into a Season tree** — click it to reveal each season, or use **Expand all / Collapse all**. Selecting the show lets you edit the title once for every season; selecting a single season focuses just its files. Scattered loose episodes of the same show are gathered together automatically, and each season is filed into its own Season N/ folder.



The Expanse expands into Season 3 and Season 4. The inspector lists the resulting files per season — e.g. `The.Expanse.S03E01.Fight.Or.Flight...` → `The Expanse/Season 3/The Expanse S03E01.mkv`.

4 Acronyms — keep them shouting, or not

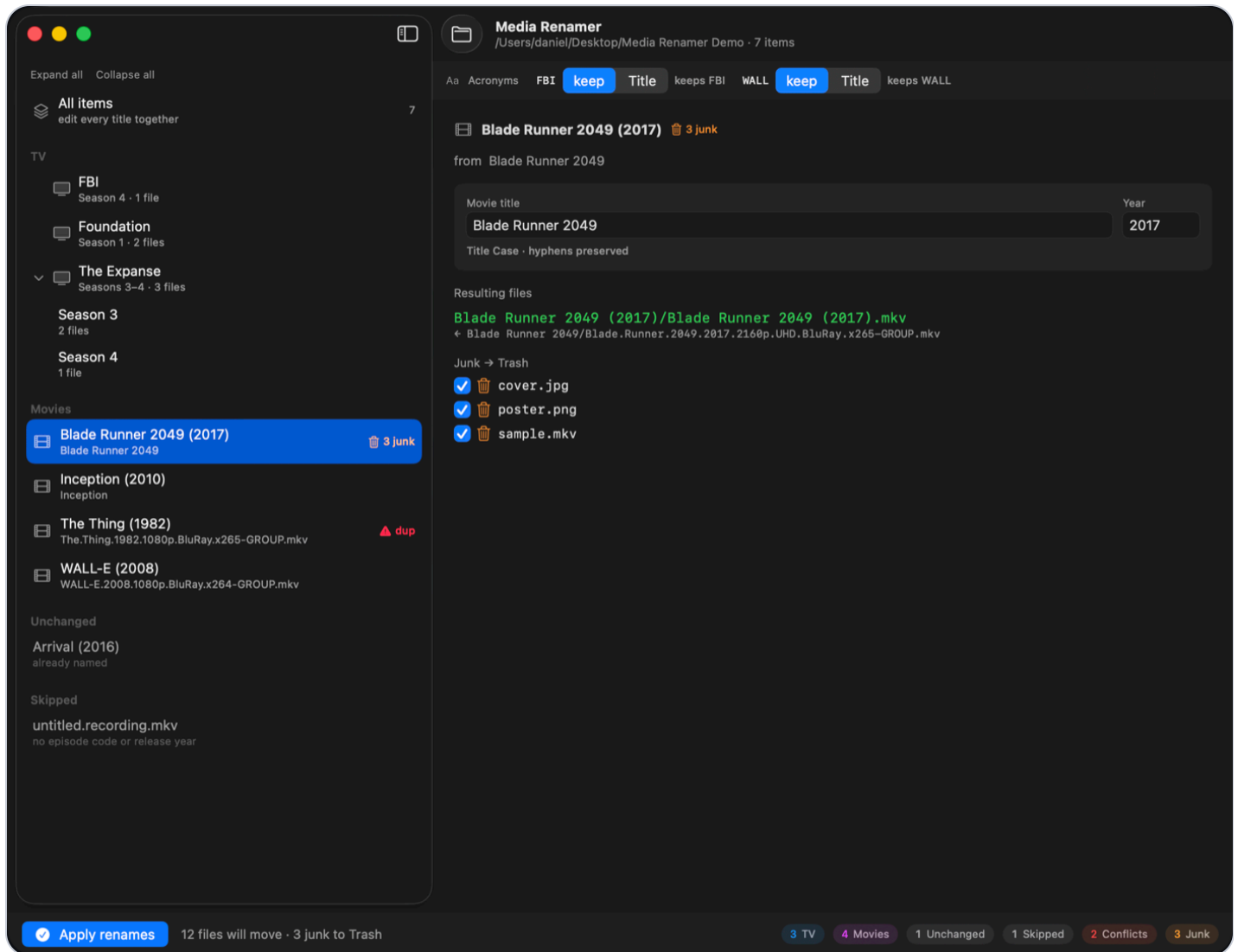
Title-casing would happily turn FBI into “Fbi”. To prevent that, the app spots all-caps words in your titles and shows them in the **acronym bar** across the top, each with a **keep / Title** toggle. The app pre-selects **keep** for short acronyms (about four letters or fewer) and **Title** for longer all-caps words — flip either as needed. With **keep**, FBI stays FBI; choose **Title** for a word that should be capitalised normally. Your choices are remembered for next time.



The acronym bar detected FBI and WALL (from WALL-E) and is keeping both as-is, so the output stays FBI/Season 4/FBI S04E01.mkv.

5 Send the junk to the Trash

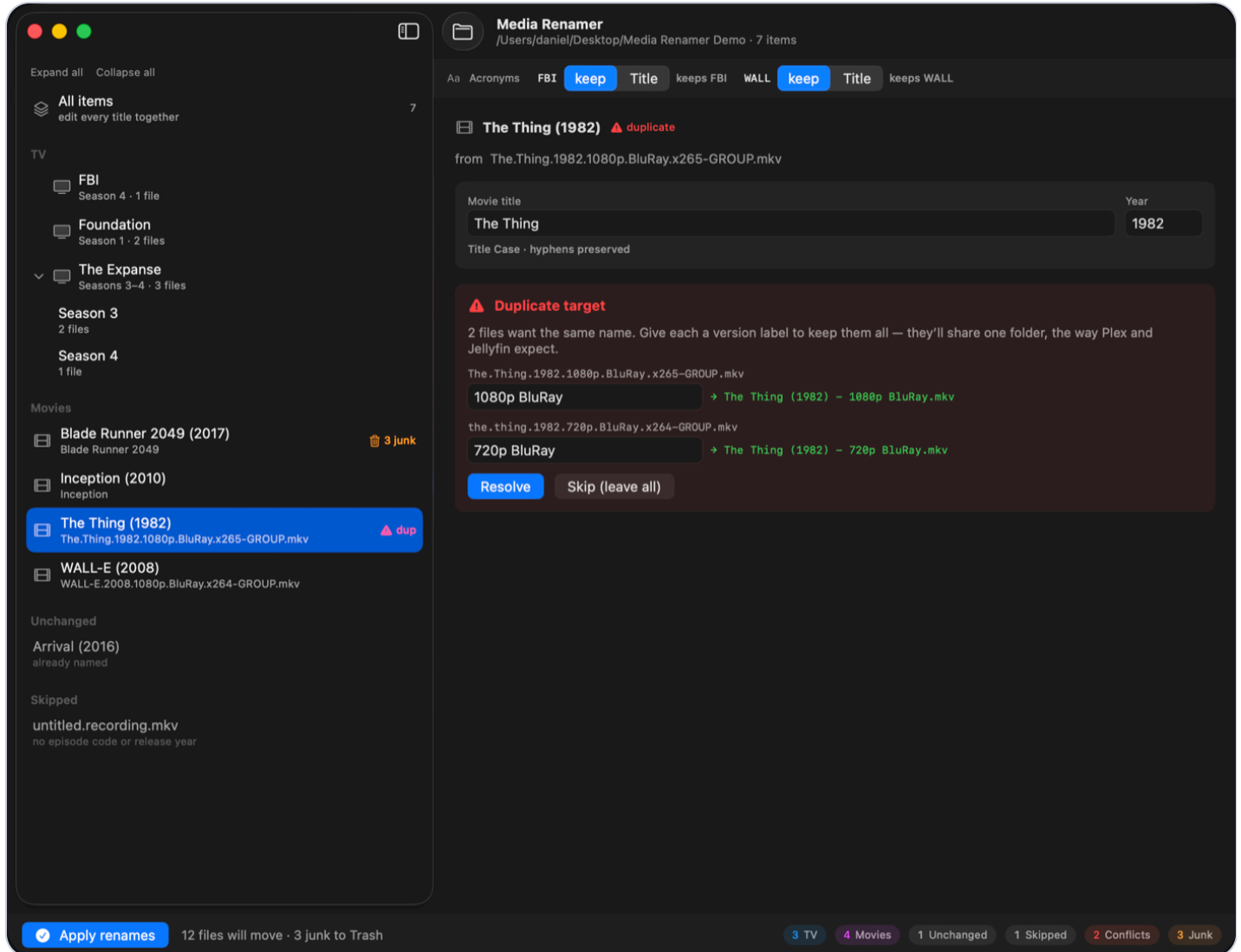
Sample clips, cover art, screenshots, “proof” images — the flotsam that ships alongside a download — are flagged as **junk**. For any item that contains some, the inspector lists each junk file with a checkbox. Checked files go to the macOS **Trash** when you Apply; un-check anything you’d rather keep. Because it’s the real Trash, you can always **Put Back** later.



Blade Runner 2049 renames cleanly while its extras — `cover.jpg`, `poster.png`, `sample.mkv` — are queued for the Trash. Uncheck any to keep it.

6 Two copies of the same thing? Keep both.

If two files would land on the *same* name — say a 1080p and a 720p rip of one movie — they're flagged **duplicate**. Instead of skipping one, the **resolver** lets you keep them all: it reads each file's quality and pre-fills a **version label**, and shows a live preview of the result. Click **Resolve** and both versions land in one folder as **Title (Year) – 1080p BluRay.mkv** and ... – **720p BluRay.mkv** — exactly the “versions” layout Plex and Jellyfin understand. Prefer to do nothing? **Skip (leave all)** leaves them untouched.



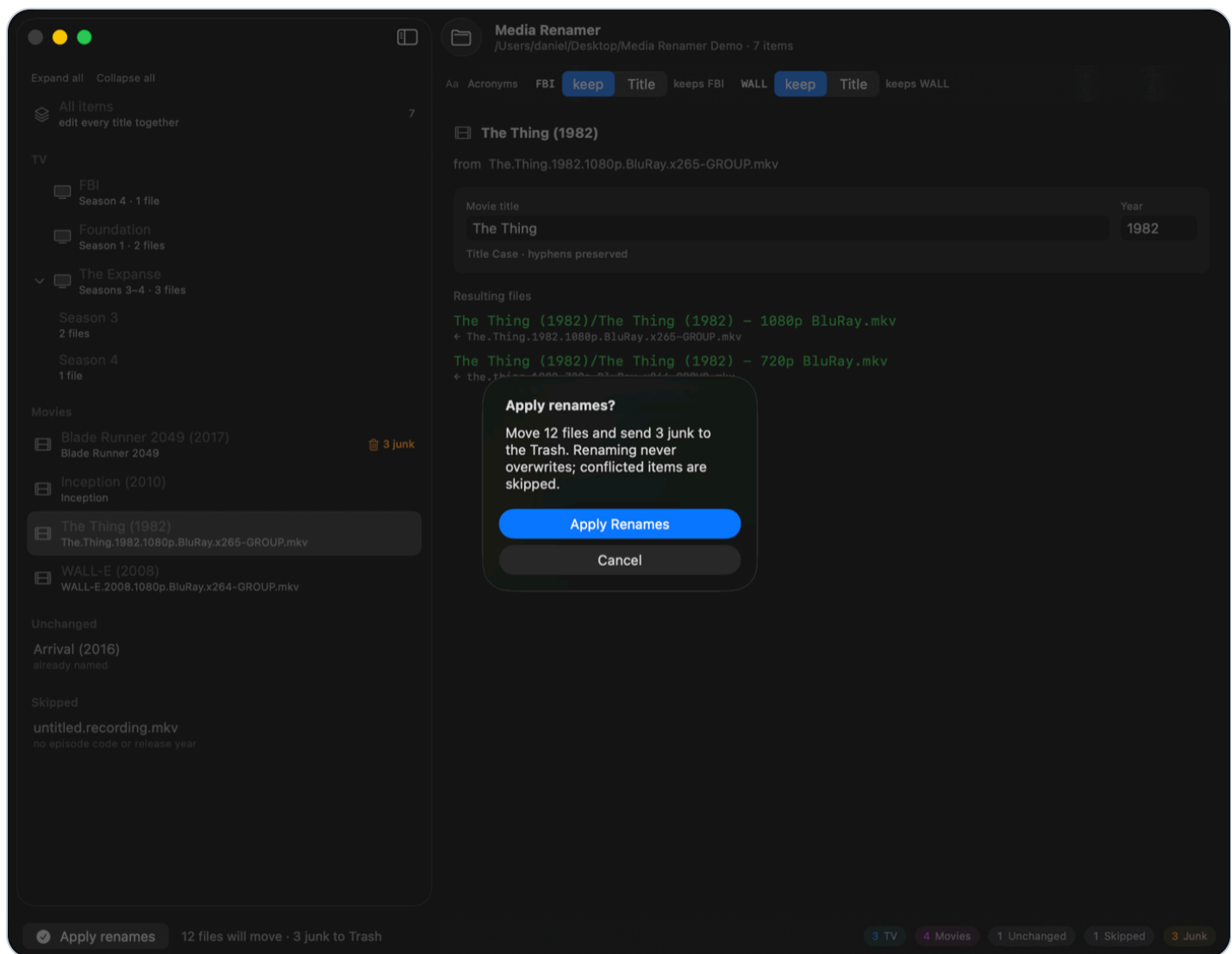
The resolver for **The Thing (1982)**. Each version gets a label, so both are kept side by side instead of one being skipped.

What happens to unresolved duplicates?

If you leave a duplicate unresolved, those colliding files are simply **skipped** at Apply — nothing is overwritten or lost. You can come back and resolve them on a later run.

7 Apply — the only step that touches disk

Happy with the preview? Click **Apply renames** in the bottom bar. A confirmation dialog sums up exactly what will happen — how many files move, how many go to the Trash — and reminds you that nothing gets overwritten. Click **Apply Renames** to go ahead, or **Cancel** to keep tweaking.

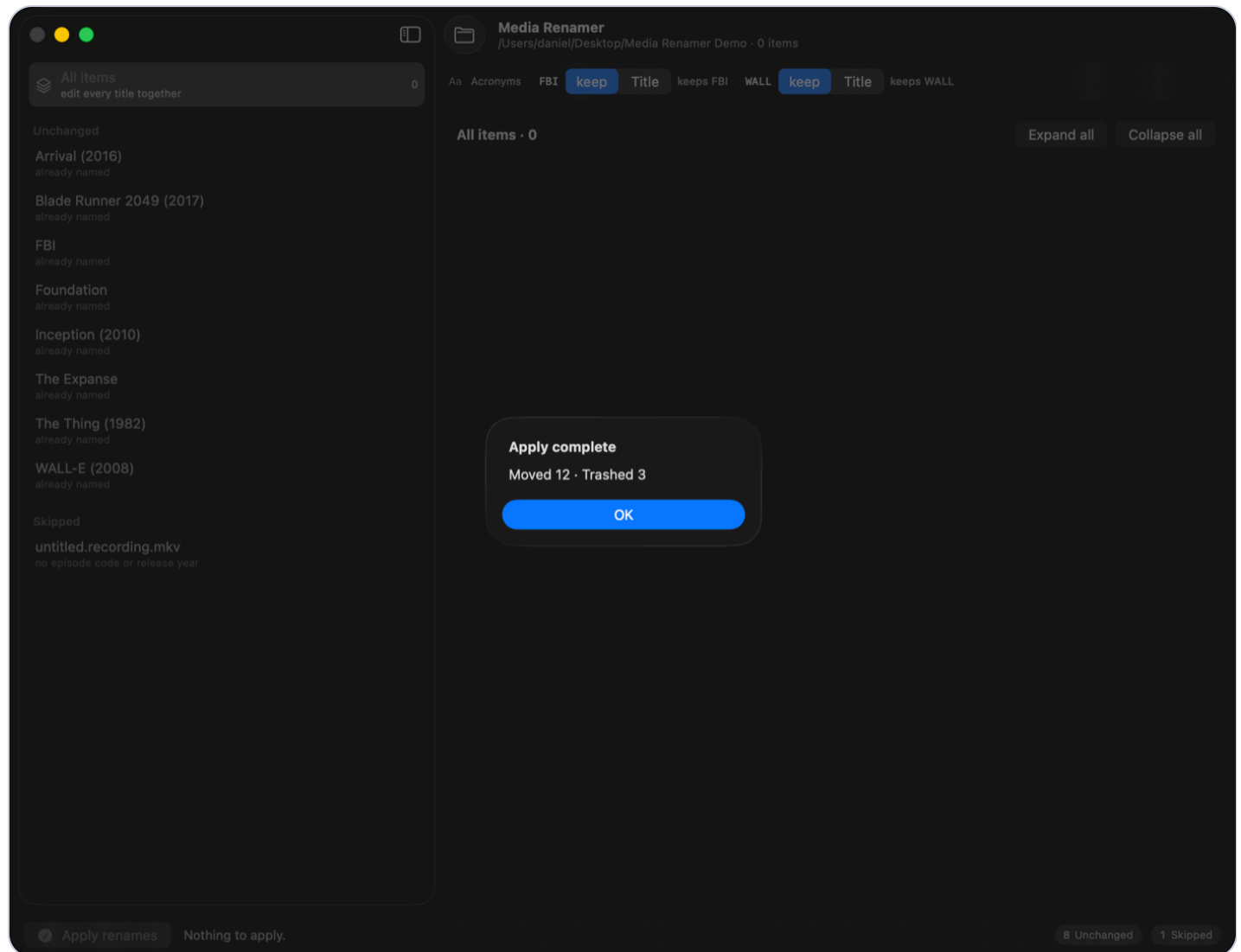


The confirmation before anything changes. This is your last checkpoint.

8 Done — and safe to run again

Apply does the work — renames, sends the checked junk to the Trash, and tidies up any now-empty source folders — then re-scans and reports a quick summary. After

organising, every *renameable* item shows up as **Unchanged**; the only thing left is the one file it couldn't recognise, still parked under **Skipped**. Running Media Renamer again on an already-tidy folder does nothing, so it's safe to re-run anytime new files arrive.



Apply complete — Moved 12 · Trashed 3. The renamed files now sit under **Unchanged** — only the unrecognised `untitled.recording.mkv` stays in **Skipped** — and there's nothing left to apply.

Reference

What the app treats each file as

KIND	WHAT IT IS	WHAT HAPPENS
Video	.mkv	Renamed into the Plex/Jellyfin layout.
Subtitle (sidecar)	.srt .sub .idx .ass .ssa .vtt	Renamed to sit beside its video, keeping recognised language codes.
Junk	Anything else, plus names like sample, screens, proof, thumbs	Offered for the Trash (per-file checkbox).
Ignored	Library folders Movies/Music/TV and hidden/metadata files (.DS_Store, ._*)	Left completely alone.

How names are decided

TV vs. Movie

An episode code (S01E01, S01E01-E02, four-digit seasons like S2024E01...) means TV. Otherwise a release year means a movie. Neither? It's skipped.

Finding the year

A clean Title (YYYY) wins; otherwise a scene-style .YYYY. next to a quality tag; otherwise the right-most plausible year — so a year that's part of the title (e.g. Blade Runner 2049) isn't mistaken for a release year.

Tidying the title

Dots become spaces, : becomes " - ", hyphens are kept, and the title is Title-Cased with small words (a, the, of...) left lowercase — except the first and last words, which are always capitalised. AKA titles keep the English side.

Good to know

- **Preview is read-only.** Only **Apply** writes to disk, and it always confirms first.
- **Nothing is overwritten.** If a target name already exists, that item is skipped.

- **Junk is recoverable.** It goes to the macOS Trash — use Finder's **Put Back** to undo.
- **Renames don't have an in-app undo yet**, so review the preview before applying.
Working on a copy is the safest habit.
- **It re-runs cleanly.** The app recognises its own output, so re-scanning an organised folder is a no-op.